A BEGINNER'S GUIDE TO VIBE CODING: BUILD FOR YOUR BUSINESS. THINK LIKE AN ENGINEER.



VINNY SOSA

Lead Marketing AI Solutions Architect

ServiceTitan

MAICON FORWARD

#MAICON26

Solutions Architect · 16 Years

> Give me a business problem, I'll hand you the system that solves it. The data model. The integrations. The architecture. That part was never the issue. The issue was building it myself.

01 **Revenue-driver projects**

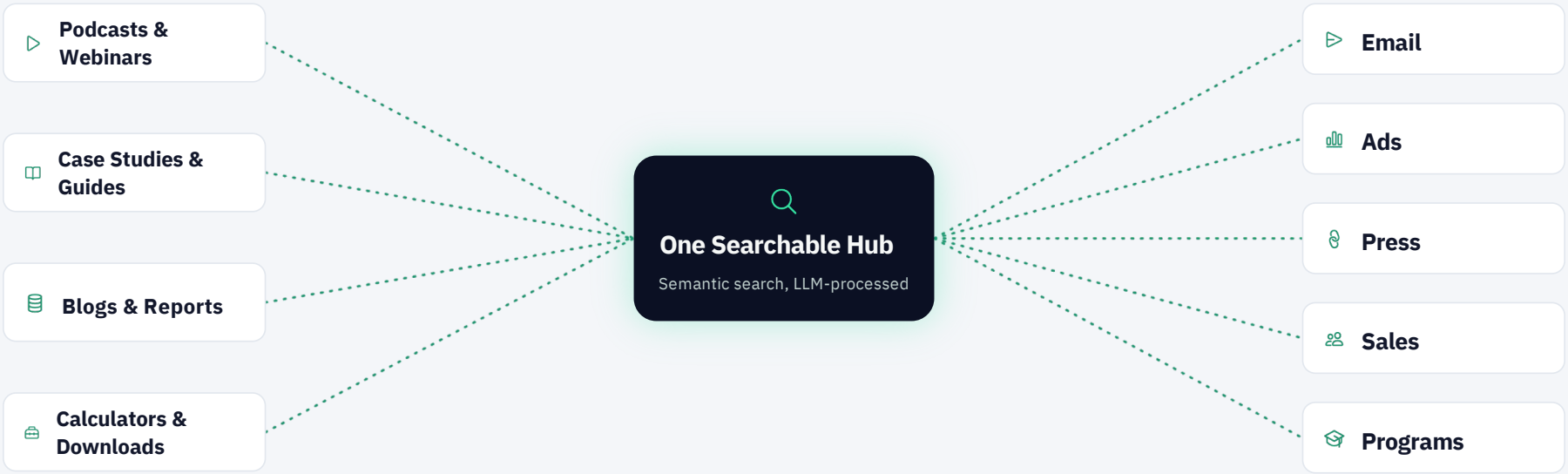
02 **Ops improvements**

⬇ *the back of the line*

03 **Innovation & Experimentation**

Why Marketing Mind?

Content silos → Centralize → Activate



Chat, copy, paste — twice!
Grrr.



Going around the process, not through it.

The deeper mistake wasn't the tool. It was me.



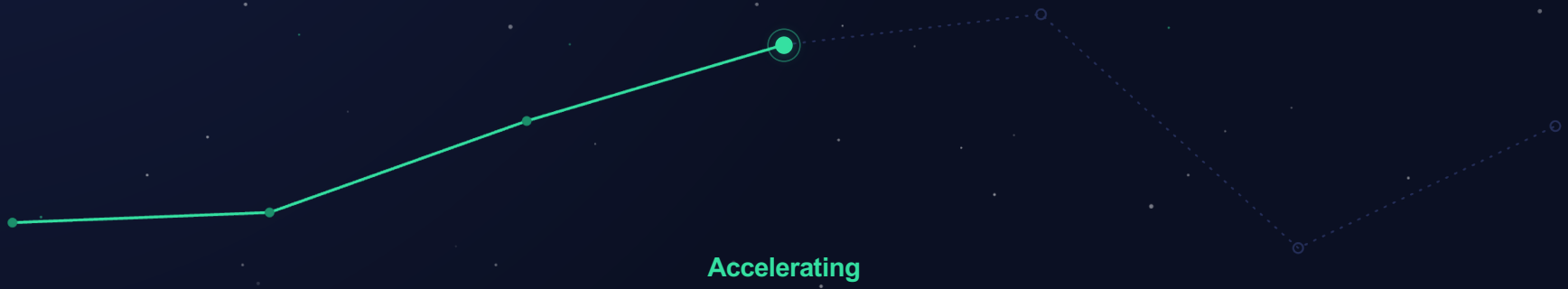
One click into VS Code.

The right tool doesn't make AI a little better. It makes it orders of magnitude better.



GitHub + Terraform + GCP, wired up.

Game on.



Unstoppable has a cost.

It's not just tokens — it's mental health and work-life balance.



Not more output. More discipline.

AI can be addictive. Reinvest savings in discipline —
not more work, not less family or friends.



Still learning.

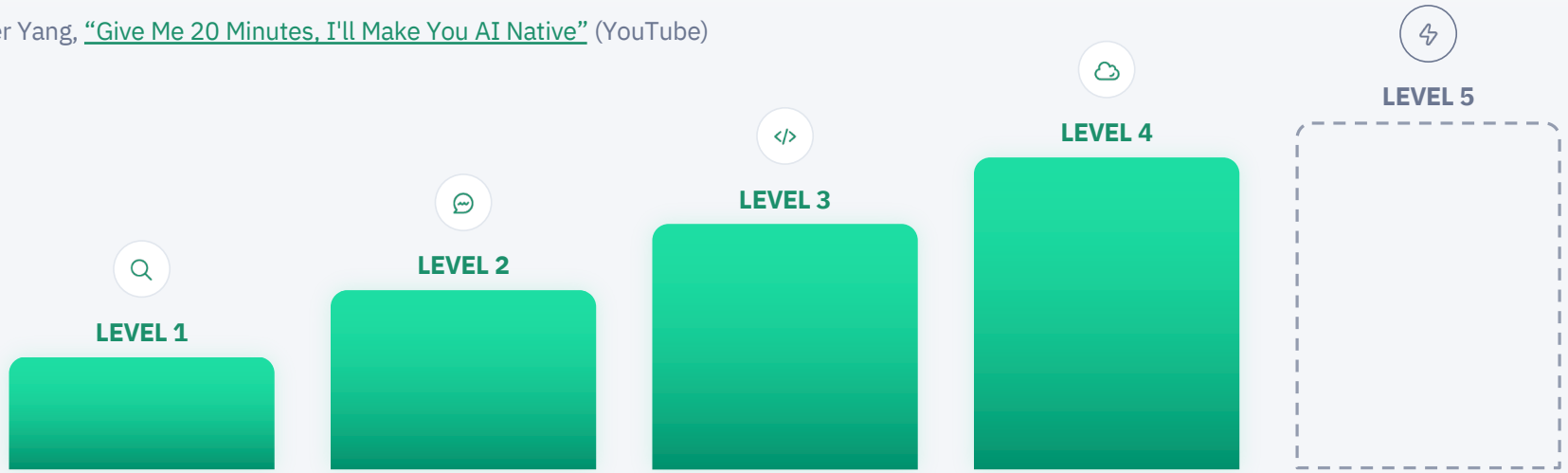
Never let AI steal a learning moment from you.
Be relentless about ownership and paranoid about output.



FIVE LEVELS

Peter Yang's AI adoption ladder

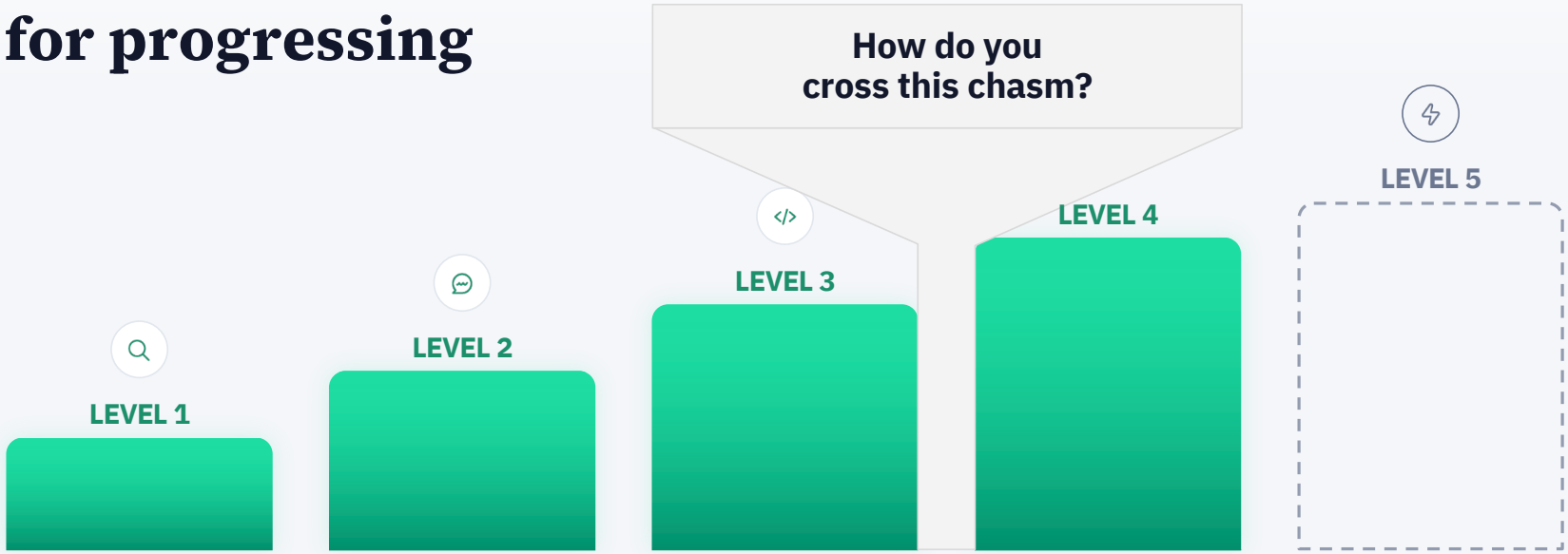
Source: Peter Yang, “Give Me 20 Minutes, I'll Make You AI Native” (YouTube)



AI as:	Search engine	Productivity partner	Prototyper & Utility creator	Full app developer/ engineer	Autonomous builder

FIVE LEVELS

Tips for progressing



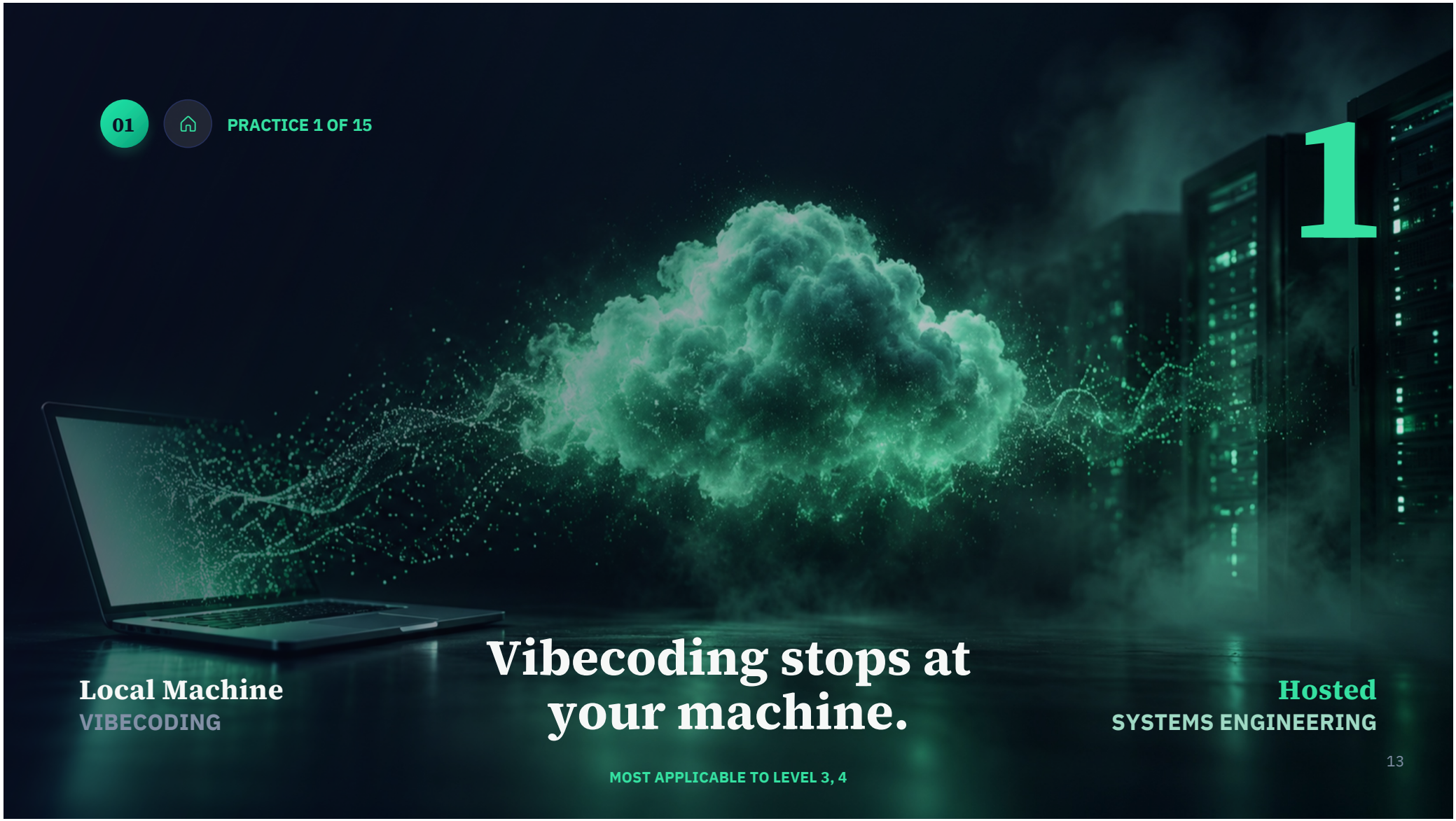
	LEVEL 1	LEVEL 2	LEVEL 3	LEVEL 4	LEVEL 5
Common Tools:	Web-based LLM or AI-Search	Gemini, ChatGPT, Claude w/Skills, MCPs, etc.	AI Studio, CoWork, ChatGPT Work, ***Replit, Lovable***	Antigravity, Cursor, Claude Code, Codex, ***Replit, Lovable***	Autonomous builder



Brave enough for Level 5? Talk to **Jordache Johnson** — he's lives there.
linkedin.com/in/jordachejohnson

What I learned.

Avoid my mistakes if you can.


01
PRACTICE 1 OF 15
1
Local Machine
VIBECODING
Vibecoding stops at your machine.
Hosted
SYSTEMS ENGINEERING
MOST APPLICABLE TO LEVEL 3, 4

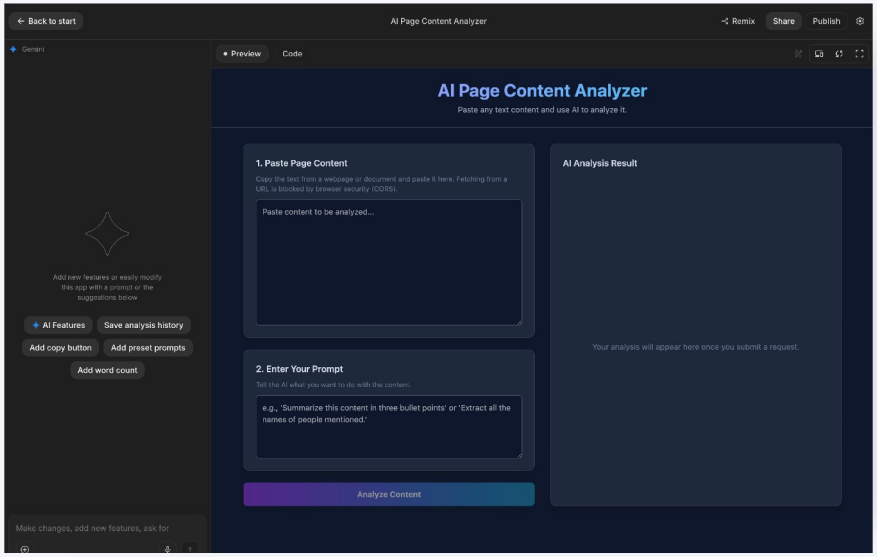
02

PRACTICE 2 OF 15

Use the right tool for the desired outcome

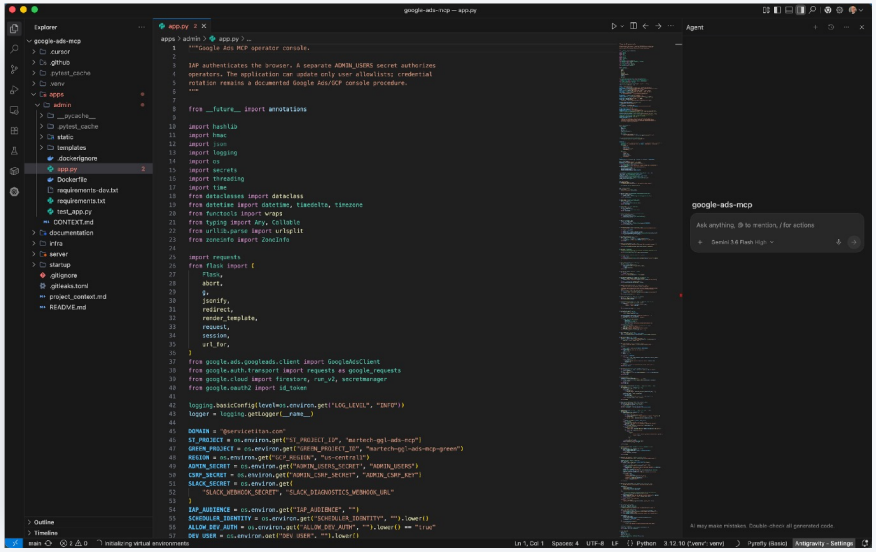
2

This is how you stay firmly in the drivers seat.



e.g. AI Studio is a great Level 3 tool

chat-first — the build stays behind the glass



e.g. Google Antigravity is required at Level 4

agentic IDE — the file tree stays in view

MOST APPLICABLE TO LEVEL 3, 4, 5

03 PRACTICE 3 OF 15

You don't always need cloud infrastructure

3

Don't take AI's word for it. You don't always need deployed infrastructure.

Google Workspace

Apps Script + Sheets, Docs, Forms, Slides, Sites

- Host a simple utility or dashboard for a small team
- Less risk — no cloud infrastructure
- Access control built-in

GitHub Pages

A lightweight web experience for a small team

- Free hosting, straight from your repo
- No servers, no cloud bill, no infrastructure to patch
- Git is already your source of truth

MOST APPLICABLE TO LEVEL 3, 4

04 PRACTICE 4 OF 15

Requirements Before Code

4

80% planning. 20% typing.

- More accurate AI output
- Less token waste (less rework)
- This is where AI can "build overnight" with the right controls in place:
  - Limited to specific folders
  - Limited to specific actions
  - No deploy rights

MOST APPLICABLE TO LEVEL 3, 4, 5

05 PRACTICE 5 OF 15

Assume the Handoff

Build it assuming the next person.

5

- Someone else may inherit this—likely not by choice
- Avoid buildup of needless technical debt
- Cleaner hand-off with less rework

You may not control the handoff but
you must control your reputation.

MOST APPLICABLE TO LEVEL 3, 4, 5

06

06

PRACTICE 6 OF 15

Mechanize Everything You Can

Deterministic → script it. Generative → AI.

- Using AI for repeatable work wastes tokens
- Scripting makes critical work 100% repeatable
- Mechanization saves you tokens and time



MOST APPLICABLE TO LEVEL 2, 3, 4, 5

07 PRACTICE 7 OF 15

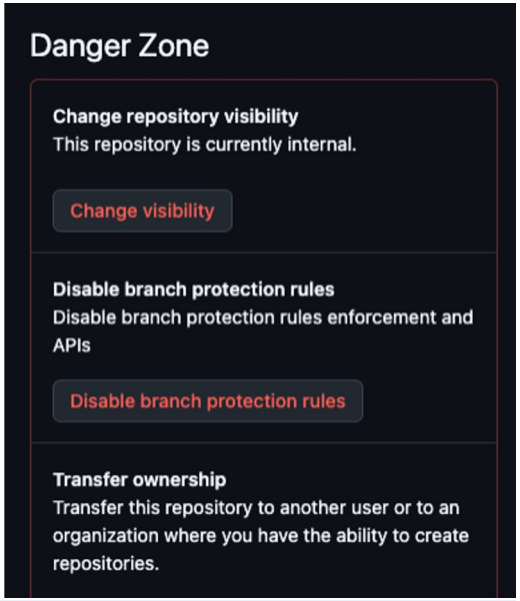
Get Good at Keeping Secrets

7

Never public. Never in the code. Never in chat.

- Your entire codebase is a secret. NO PUBLIC REPOSITORY!
  - Set when creating the repo
  - Set in Repo > Settings > General > Danger Zone
- Secrets go in a secrets manager — never in the code
- Keep .env files outside of your project & loaded to memory
- Use a password manager to share keys

Ask AI where secrets belong, not just how to use them



MOST APPLICABLE TO LEVEL 3, 4, 5

08

PRACTICE 8 OF 15

8

Track Your Work

Know exactly what changed.

- Every release gets a number and commit messages
- Use Architectural Decision Records (ADRs) to document progress and choices
- Test results and checklists get pushed with the release
- You always know where you stand — and where to roll back to

MOST APPLICABLE TO LEVEL 4, 5

09 ⚠ PRACTICE 9 OF 15

9

Don't Create Sh-- (CRAP)

Start with a 500-line rule → adopt CRAP score later.

- AI will keep extending file length without guard rails
- Line limits are a good first rule of thumb (< 500 lines/file)
  - Mistakes hurt more at 7,000 lines than 200
  - Long files cost more tokens to edit and are riskier to change
  - Make it harder for development teams to collaborate on
- More Advanced? Use CRAP Model (Change Risk Analysis & Predictions)

  $complexity^2 \times (1 - coverage\%)^3 + complexity$

MOST APPLICABLE TO LEVEL 4, 5

10 PRACTICE 10 OF 15

Anchor (Pin) Your Dependencies

10

Exact versions. No open door for drift.

- Dependencies are public/open-source libraries used in your code
- Pinning is when your code indicates the specific version to use
- AI has a tendency to not pin which can introduce security risk and drift
- Pin every dependency to an exact version

Don't let 3rd parties evolve your code under you!

MOST APPLICABLE TO LEVEL 4, 5

11

PRACTICE 11 OF 15

Infrastructure as Code

Never click it into existence.

11

- Every resource defined in code (e.g. Terraform), not clicked into a console
- A developer or coding agent can read it and understand the whole system
- Copies for all your environments can easily be deployed over and over

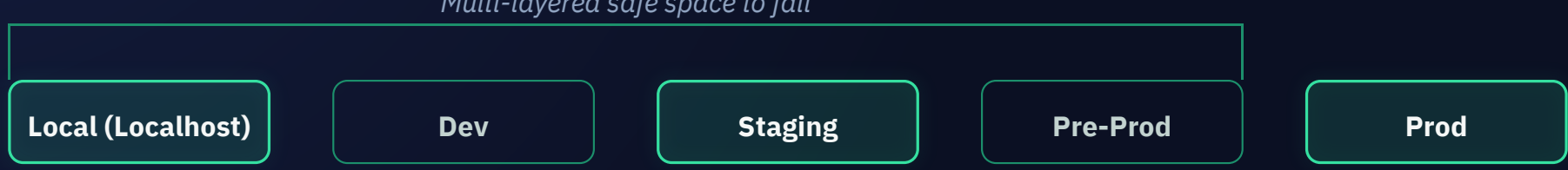
MOST APPLICABLE TO LEVEL 4, 5

12 PRACTICE 12 OF 15

Separate Dev from Prod

Break things on purpose — just not in prod.

12



Protecting production is the mission.

MOST APPLICABLE TO LEVEL 4, 5

13

PRACTICE 13 OF 15

Own Security

Ask AI to help you review.

13

- Audit your code/app like an engineer — use scripts, tools, and AI
- Use multi-model challenge (e.g. Different models working against each other)
- Github's Dependabot is the absolute minimum you can do
- Findings go to the backlog, but high priority alerts get fixed immediately
- Don't let security issues become debt — prioritize security over new features

Assume a hacking attempt will be made as soon as you go live!

MOST APPLICABLE TO LEVEL 4, 5

14 PRACTICE 14 OF 15

Make Commits Work for You

Checked before it ships.

14

- Configure commits & pushes to trigger a pre-deployment workflow
- Auto-run mandatory unit testing before releases leave staging
- Automate secret scanning, linting, and a dependency-vulnerability scans
- Nothing merges until every gate passes

This isn't just automation — it's refusing to trust AI's word for it

MOST APPLICABLE TO LEVEL 4, 5

15

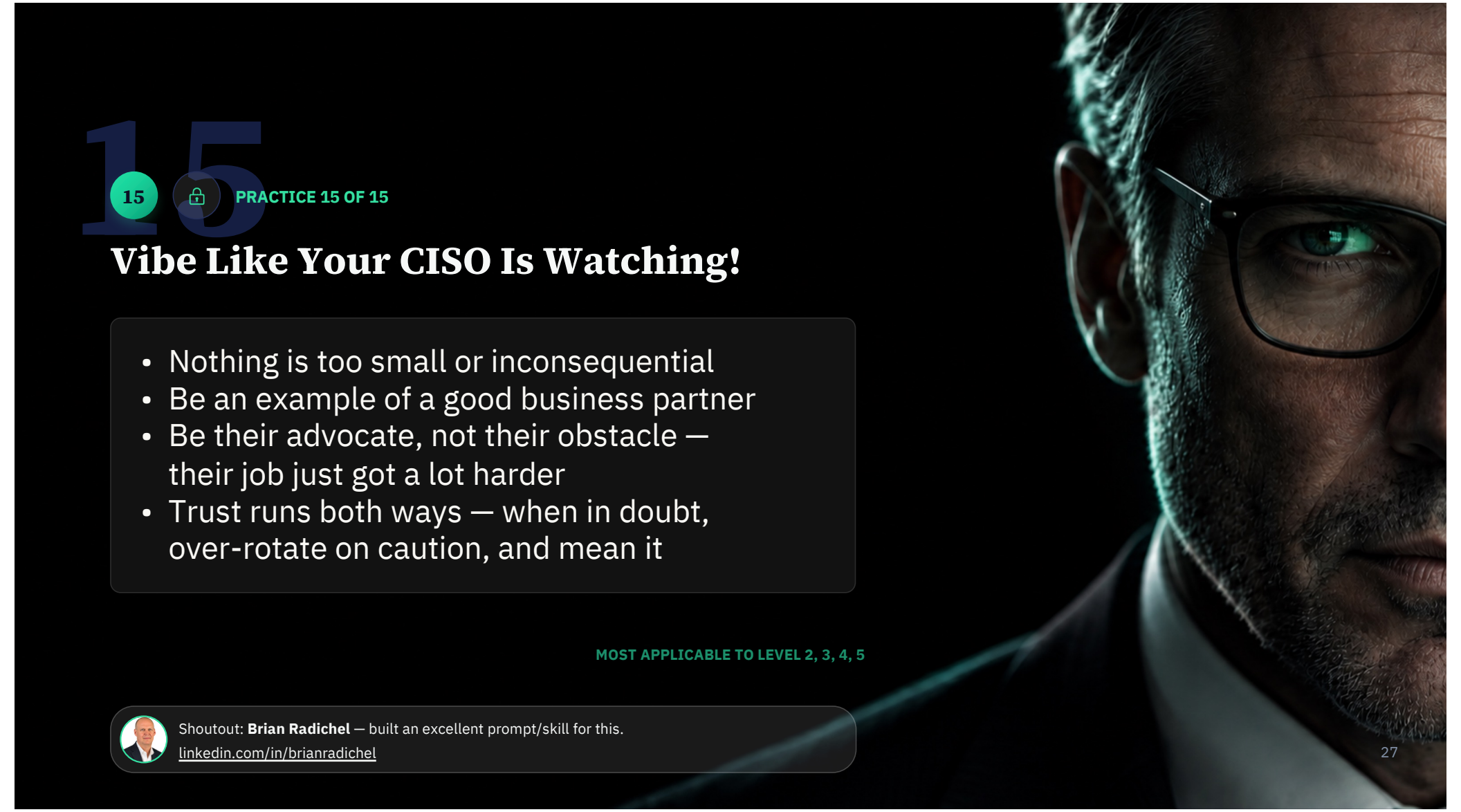
15 PRACTICE 15 OF 15

Vibe Like Your CISO Is Watching!

- Nothing is too small or inconsequential
- Be an example of a good business partner
- Be their advocate, not their obstacle — their job just got a lot harder
- Trust runs both ways — when in doubt, over-rotate on caution, and mean it

MOST APPLICABLE TO LEVEL 2, 3, 4, 5

Shoutout: **Brian Radichel** — built an excellent prompt/skill for this.
linkedin.com/in/brianradichel



MARKETING MIND TODAY

Real Impact

255

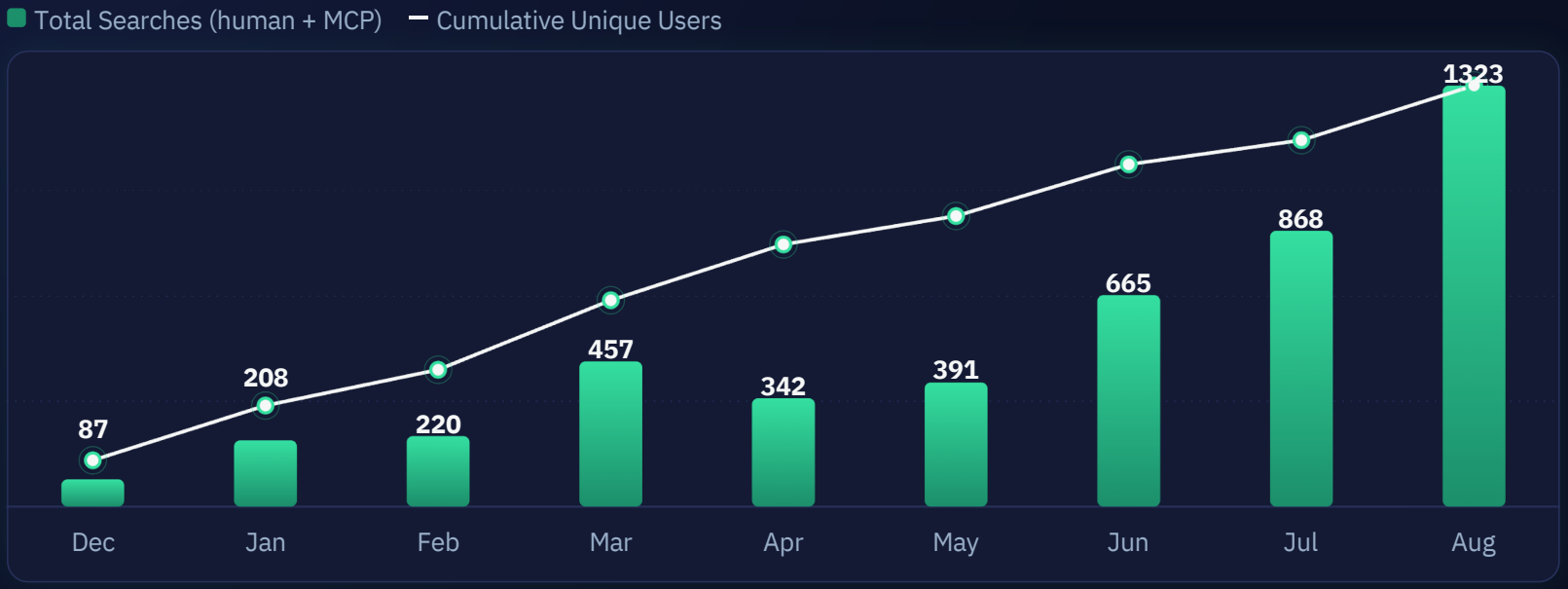
cumulative unique users

952

searches / month (3-mo avg, Jun–Aug)

73%

AI searches → follow-up email



Scale context: 3,880 documents · 7 trades · 7 ServiceTitan-family products — one searchable thing where there used to be silos.

You don't need to be an engineer
to vibe code meaningful applications.

But you do need to think like one.

Vinny Sosa · find me after, or at linkedin.com/in/vinnys

MAICON FORWARD

VINNY SOSA

Lead Marketing AI Solutions Architect

ServiceTitan

/in/vinnys

THANK YOU! WE APPRECIATE YOUR SESSION FEEDBACK.

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